

product launches, we aim to penetrate new markets, particularly in key regions like Europe and Asia.”

Saldanha says Glenmark uses its scientific expertise and robust development capabilities to climb the value chain towards complex generics and speciality medicines.

The company’s growth extends across all key emerging markets, with strategic partnerships enhancing its capabilities. In dermatology, Glenmark acquired exclusive rights to commercialise Winlevi, an anti-acne cream, in Europe and South Africa. The company collaborated with Pfizer in India to market abrocitinib, which is used to treat atopic dermatitis, the most common form of eczema.

Saldanha highlights the potential of a licence agreement with Jiangsu Alphamab Biopharmaceuticals and 3D Medicines (Beijing) for Envafolelimab, an injection for treating certain advanced solid tumours and cancer in India, Asia Pacific, West Asia, Africa, Russia, the Commonwealth of Independent States, and Latin America.

INNOVATION ENGINE

“Innovation is deeply ingrained in Glenmark’s ethos. With a legacy of over two decades in new drug discovery, we have out-licensed nine clinical stage assets, totalling around \$300 million,” Saldanha says.

Earlier this year, Glenmark announced a partnership with its biotech subsidiary, Ichnos Sciences Inc., to form Ichnos Glenmark Innovation (IGI), an alliance to advance cancer treatment. The IGI alliance combines Glenmark’s expertise in the research and development of small molecules with Ichnos’s skill in creating novel biologics. Its focus is on developing innovative therapies for treating haematological malignancies and solid tumours.

IGI’s pipeline has three innovative oncology molecules in clinical trials. The

US FDA has granted two of them “orphan drug” designation, which entitles special support to drugs that show promise in treating, preventing, or diagnosing rare diseases but don’t have a mass market.

Saldanha says IGI has out-licensed two drugs for autoimmune diseases to prominent companies. “All of Glenmark’s investments in innovative assets will be channelled through IGI. This alliance marks a significant step towards Glenmark’s vision of introducing novel drugs from India to the global market while optimising development costs and delivering long-term value to shareholders,” says Saldanha.

The company recently secured an out-licensing deal for its OX40 antagonist monoclonal antibody portfolio, further amplifying Glenmark’s credibility as a leading research-led pharmaceutical company from India.

CONSOLIDATION FOR GROWTH

According to the wealth management platform KRChoksey, Glenmark Pharmaceuticals is the 14th in India’s market, with a share of about 2.13%. Glenmark also has nine brands among the top 300, and is second in respiratory and dermatology, fifth in cardiac, and 17th in diabetes, according to the IQVIA MAT February 2024.

Glenmark reckons profitable growth will come from a sharper focus on complex generics, including injectables, drug-device combinations, and respiratory products

Glenmark’s commitment to pioneering products is evident in Zita DM, a tailored formulation for diabetic patients. KRChoksey praises this as meeting a crucial market need. They also highlight Glenmark’s first biosimilar, Lirafit, of liraglutide, an anti-diabetic, in India.

“Glenmark has shifted to a formulations-only model, focussing on key therapeutic areas. Its high-margin India and RoW sales and a recovering US market are expected to drive growth. Cost optimisation efforts and a reduction in innovation R&D spending will enhance profitability and potentially bridge the valuation gap with peers,” says Nitin Agarwal, Managing Director & Head of Institutional Equity Research, Lead Analyst, Healthcare, Pharmaceuticals and Chemicals, DAM Capital Advisors Ltd. **BT**

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